

词汇: *pets and emotions* 宠物和情感

- 1 Everyone knows that dogs are supposed to be our best friends. Could it be that they know what we are thinking? Whether it's getting **excited** at the prospect of a walk or knowing that tasty food is coming soon, are our dogs reading our minds?
- 2 Now, by mind-reading we're not talking about knowing our **deepest thoughts** in detail, but various **psychologists** have suggested that dogs might have a **theory of mind**. What this means is that they are **aware** that other creatures, like humans, are able to see and understand things in different ways. In various experiments it appears that dogs are able to identify who is **paying** them **attention**. They are more likely to ask for food from someone if there is a reason that the human would know where the dog treats are. If dogs have been **forbidden** food by someone, they are more likely to try and get it quietly.
- 3 As well as these **behavioural** studies, there are other things that show how dogs are able to relate closely to humans. **Brain imaging** studies have shown not only that **canine** brains react to human voices, but that they also show an **emotional response** to those human sounds which demonstrate strong feelings, such as laughing or crying. **Brain scan** studies have also shown that human faces also **provoke** an emotional response in dogs. Other studies have shown that sweat from people feeling scared could make dogs feel more **stressed** than sweat from happy people.
- 4 There is some debate about whether dogs have **evolved** to respond to human emotions as they have become **domesticated** or whether this behaviour is a **learned reaction** to **stimuli**. Experiments like those described above have also been carried out on wolves that have been raised by humans, who may have learned to respond to their **carer's** behaviour, but do not have the **genes** of a domesticated species. Wolves did show some abilities to respond to human emotions, but were less able to pick up more **subtle** clues.
- 5 Whether it's learned or **innate**, dogs' ability to read human emotions and intentions are one reason that we have included them in our lives for centuries. It's also why they have been successful as assistance dogs, helping their owners to get through everyday life.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

Paragraph 5 _____

- a. nature or nurture
- b. companions and assistants
- c. not just cats
- d. different perspectives
- e. canine brain responses
- f. friendly mind readers?

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Dogs develop a detailed picture of what we are thinking.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

2. Look at paragraph 3. What does 'they' refer to in the following sentence? '**They** are more likely to ask for food from someone if there is a reason that the human would know where the dog treats are.'

- a. humans
- b. psychologists
- c. dogs

3. Dogs know when they have to be secretive when getting food.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

4. Dogs show greater emotional responses than other commonly domesticated animals.

- a. True
- b. False
- c. Not given

5. Dogs are better than wolves at responding to _____ signs from their carers.
- a. obvious
 - b. subtle
 - c. quick

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

It has been suggested that dogs have a **1)** _____ – they understand the perspective of others. **2)** _____ studies have shown how dogs act in response to humans' actions. It appears that they are **3)** _____ of what humans might be thinking. **4)** _____ to familiar faces and voices can be seen on brain scans. Studies have tried to show whether these reactions are **5)** _____ or learned behaviours.

subtle	aware	domesticated
behavioural		innate
emotional responses		theory of mind

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

excited	兴奋的，激动的
deepest thought	内心最深处的想法
psychologist	心理学家
theory of mind	心智理论
aware	意识到的
pay attention	关注，注意
forbid	禁止，不准
behavioural	行为上的
brain imaging	脑成像
canine	犬科动物的
emotional response	情感反应
brain scan	脑部扫描
provoke	激起，引起
stressed	焦虑的，紧张的
evolve	进化
domesticated	驯化的
learned reaction	后天习得的反应
stimulus	刺激，刺激物
carer	照顾者，看护者
gene	基因
subtle	微妙的，含蓄的
innate	先天的

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **f) friendly mind readers?**

Paragraph 2 **d) different perspectives**

Paragraph 3 **e) canine brain responses**

Paragraph 4 **a) nature or nurture**

Paragraph 5 **b) companions and assistants**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b. False.** *Now, by mind-reading we're **not talking about knowing our deepest thoughts in detail**, but various psychologists have suggested that dogs might have a theory of mind.*

2. **c.** The pronoun 'they' refers to dogs in the previous sentence. *In various experiments it appears that **dogs** are able to identify who is paying them attention'.*

3. **a. True.** *If dogs have been **forbidden** food by someone, they are **more likely to try and get it quietly**.*

4. **c. Not given.** The text does not mention other commonly domesticated animals.

5. **b.** *Wolves did show some abilities to respond to human emotions, but were less able to pick up more **subtle** clues.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

It has been suggested that dogs have a **theory of mind** – they understand the perspective of others. **Behavioural** studies have shown how dogs act in response to humans' actions. It appears that they are **aware** of what humans might be thinking. **Emotional responses** to familiar faces and voices can be seen on brain scans. Studies have tried to show whether these reactions are **innate** or learned behaviours.